

HANUL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

Department of Computer Engineering | FICTIONAL INSTITUTION

15 September 2026

Graduate Admissions Committee
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Cambridge, Massachusetts

Re: Recommendation for Minjun Kim

Dear Members of the Graduate Admissions Committee:

I am pleased to recommend Minjun Kim for graduate study in Electrical Engineering and Computer Science. I have worked with Minjun for two years as his research adviser in the Intelligent Systems Laboratory and previously taught him in Machine Learning. Among the approximately 120 undergraduates I have taught or supervised during the past decade, he ranks in the top five percent for research maturity, technical independence, and care in evaluating claims.

Minjun joined my laboratory with an ambitious question: could a document model explain not only what it extracted, but also when a person should distrust the extraction? His initial layout-aware pipeline performed well on clean pages but struggled with dense notices and scanned tables. Rather than adding complexity without diagnosis, he constructed an error taxonomy, isolated the major failure modes, and designed controlled experiments. His revised system improved field extraction F1 from 0.84 to 0.91 while adding calibrated confidence and evidence highlighting. This combination of modeling discipline and attention to human use is unusual at the undergraduate level.

His strongest quality is intellectual honesty. During one project review, Minjun discovered that a promising gain came partly from duplicated templates across the training and test sets. He immediately reported the issue, rebuilt the split, and reran every experiment. The corrected improvement was smaller but defensible. That decision delayed a submission, yet it strengthened the work and set an excellent standard for the rest of the group.

Minjun is also a generous collaborator. He created onboarding notebooks for new lab members, reviewed junior students' code, and translated technical discussions between our modeling and interface teams. As president of the AI Student Society, he organized a reading group that grew from twelve to more than forty regular participants. His ability to make complex ideas understandable will serve him well in a demanding research community.

I believe Minjun is ready for graduate-level research in trustworthy machine learning, document intelligence, and human-AI interaction. He has the mathematical preparation to engage with new methods, the engineering ability to build complete systems, and the judgment to evaluate them responsibly. I recommend him with enthusiasm and without reservation.

Sincerely,

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